

South Indian Low-Carb Nipattu

A crunchy South Indian-style savory cracker made lower carb with almond flour and coconut flour while still keeping the classic spicy, nutty Nipattu flavor and texture. These work beautifully as tea-time snacks, travel snacks, or crunchy accompaniments to chai.

Ingredients

- 1 1/2 cups besan (chickpea flour)
- 1/2 cup almond flour
- 4 tbsp coconut flour
- 1/4 cup ghee OR melted coconut oil
- 1/4 to 1/3 cup water (adjust gradually)
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/2 tsp turmeric powder (optional)
- 1 tsp red chili powder
- 1/2 tsp asafoetida (hing)
- 2 tsp sesame seeds
- 3–4 green chilies, finely chopped (optional)
- 2 tsp ajwain OR cumin seeds
- 1/2 cup raw peanuts, coarsely crushed

Method — Prepare the Dough

- Mix besan, almond flour, coconut flour, spices, seeds, and crushed peanuts in a bowl.
- Rub ghee thoroughly into the flour mixture until crumbly.
- Add water gradually while mixing.
- Form a stiff but pliable dough.
- Rest dough 10–15 minutes for hydration.

Shaping the Nipattu

- Divide dough into small balls (about 1 tsp each).
- Flatten into thin discs slightly smaller than papdi.
- Use parchment paper or greased plastic sheet for easier flattening.

- Prick with a fork to prevent puffing.

Fried Version

- Heat oil on medium heat.
- Fry a few pieces at a time.
- Cook until golden brown and crisp.
- Drain on kitchen paper.

Baked Version

- Preheat oven to 180°C / 350°F.
- Arrange flattened discs on parchment-lined tray.
- Bake 15–20 minutes.
- Flip halfway through baking.
- Cool fully to crisp further.

Air Fryer Version

- Preheat air fryer to 170°C / 340°F.
- Air fry 8–12 minutes.
- Flip midway for even crisping.
- Cool completely before storing.

Tips & Tweaks

- Do not make dough too soft or Nipattu may lose crispness.
- Coconut flour absorbs moisture slowly — allow dough to rest before adjusting water.
- For extra crispness, flatten thinner.
- Cooling completely is important for final crunch.
- If dough cracks too much, add 1–2 tsp warm water.
- For richer taste, use ghee instead of oil.
- Adding a little rice flour gives more traditional texture but increases carbs.

Interesting Variations

- Cheesy Crunch: add 2–3 tbsp grated hard cheese.

- Garlic Version: add 1/2 tsp garlic powder.
- Extra Spicy: add black pepper and extra chili powder.
- Herb Version: add curry leaves, coriander, or dill.
- Seed Mix Version: add pumpkin and sunflower seeds.
- Methi Nipattu: add dried fenugreek leaves.
- Coconut Version: add toasted coconut flakes.
- Masala Tea-Time Version: add chaat masala after baking.

Serving Suggestions

- Serve with masala chai or coffee.
- Pair with yogurt dips or chutneys.
- Works well on snack boards.
- Can be crushed over salads or soups for crunch.

Approximate Nutrition (Per Nipattu, depending on size/yield)

- Calories: ~55–75
- Protein: ~2–3g
- Net Carbs: ~3–5g
- Fat: ~4–5g
- Fiber: ~2g

Storage

- Cool completely before storing.
- Store in airtight container.
- Keeps well for 2–3 weeks.
- Can be re-crisped briefly in oven or air fryer.